Layout modules contain just enough code to arrange the output of screen and navigation modules. They typically contain table tags, as is the custom for controlling the layout of a Web page. Inside the table cells, calls to include are placed. They may be invoking navigation modules, or screen modules.

Navigation modules contain links and repeating elements. In the vernacular used by engineers we work with, these are "top nav," "bottom nav," and "side nav." Consider the popular site, Yahoo. Their pages generally consist of the same navigation across the top and some at the bottom. Their top nav includes their logo and links to important areas of their site. If the Yahoo site were coded in FreeEnergy, there would probably be a dynamic navigation module for generating the path to the current section, such as Home > Computers and Internet > Software > Internet > World Wide Web > Servers > Server Side Scripting > PHP.

Screen modules contain the content unique to the particular page being displayed. They may be plain HTML, or they may be primarily PHP code, depending on context. A press release is static. It can be prepared by someone unfamiliar with PHP. They only need to know that the screen module is an HTML fragment.

Any module may rely on a utility module in much the same way utility files are used in other contexts. Some utility modules are called each page load. Others are collections of functions or objects related to a particular database table.

All modules are collected in a modules directory that further contains a subdirectory for each module type. To enhance security, it is placed outside of the Web server's document root. Within the document root is a single PHP script, index.php. This script begins the process of calling successive modules and structuring their output with the standard HTML tags.

9.5 FASTTEMPLATE

Fast Template is is a PHP port of the Perl CGI:FastTemplate template engine originally written by Jason Moore jmoore@sober.com.

In 1999 the development of Fast Template was abandoned by CDI but survived as a good template system over the time. Since then several people tried to add new capabilities making the code work with newer PHP versions.

Since Fast Template is still useful in PHP projects and we decided to release a version with all modifications and new capabalities that were added.

Currently it includes the merged cache function, debug console, silent removal of not-assigned dynamic blocks, ability of including PHP code into templates.

We also added a new functionality: pattern assign. When variables or constants are the same as the template keys, these functions may be used as they are. Using these functions, can help you reduce the number of the assign functions in the PHP files, which is very useful for language files.